

beginning to contribute to open source. They are steadily building the community with their new age ideas, which is shaping the open source ecosystem.

Indians have been at the forefront of contributing to well-loved open source projects like Apache, TensorFlow, React or even Kubernetes. But a new driver is accelerating the growth of the Indian open source community—the emergence of projects like MOSIP, Bagisto, ERPNext and Chatwoot, which have their origin in India and have now gone on to become globally beloved open source programs. Developers from around the world are working on these projects, helping to add more functionality, figuring out and fixing bugs, and improving them for use by governments, consumers and enterprises across the world.

This highlights how Indian developers are solving problems in the local context, which is impacting the larger picture and providing solutions to similar problems that exist elsewhere.

Propelling the startup ecosystem

The open source ecosystem in India is extremely vibrant today, and this is helping to build the tech community and complementing the startup boom that the country is currently experiencing. Startups, and SaaS (software as a service) in particular, today rely heavily on the open source model, and this is because the young founders running them are aware of how they can leverage open source.

This, in turn, is helping new talent coming out from Indian institutions that is building the code for the core functions of these startups. These companies are now going on to become global giants, all thanks to the vibrant open source and community ecosystem powering the Digital India vision.

Yet, the greatest thing about all of this is how rapidly the community in India is growing. Nearly 2 million Indian contributors have joined the

The interconnected community – going above and beyond

The Ingenuity helicopter that has been sent on a mission to Mars by NASA is a great example of how the interconnected community is contributing to larger-than-life projects. The software, code and libraries used in this helicopter have been written by hundreds of open source developers over the years who had no knowledge that they were contributing to such a project.

These developers may have just been writing a login module or creating a telemetry function that they open sourced, which has then been put together in the software that powered Ingenuity and created what may well be a breakthrough for humankind. This is just one example of how open source is enabling human progress.

Powering the interconnected community in India

Just like Indian developers are nurturing the open source community at large, it is important to provide avenues for growth for newer, younger talent to learn how to tap into their skills. GitHub has taken a few steps in that direction.

GitHub Grants for Open Source: This programme was launched by GitHub to help support projects in India, since working long-term on a particular project can be an expensive affair. GitHub Grants for Open Source commits Rs 10 million (Rs 1 crore) to support and fund open source maintainers and contributors, as they build open source software that impacts India and the world.

GitHub Accelerate: This programme aims to support startups in their technological growth by providing access to GitHub's enterprise products. The programme is currently open to startups that are a part of a select partner network consisting of accelerators, incubators and venture funds. Large organisations that have built their business model around open source or rely on it can now share their experiences with up and coming startups, and also get their engineering teams to share their strategies on scalability and security. This will help new startups learn from the best in the game.

GitHub Externship: The GitHub Externship programme provides students with a unique opportunity to engage with companies in India, via fellowship programmes. It helps them build the right skills future developers need, including open source skills, to succeed in an enterprise environment. It guides them on what it means to be part of the open source ecosystem, what the different licensing mechanisms in open source are, when to use them, and so on. Third-year students work on enterprise open source projects, which is a win-win situation since student developers get exposure to real world challenges and the industry gets some cool coding talent.

open source community in GitHub and created their first repository, collaborated with others and are on their way to build products that rely on such code. This is proof that the open source community in India is here to stay and nurture the growth of product development in the country.

All of this, though, is not happening behind-the-scenes. People have started taking note of the impact that open source has, which has sparked the interest of venture capitalists, particularly in India. The recent acquisition of a product company like Red Hat indicates that there is a good